RAY OF SICKNESS (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 1 – Necromancy
Casting Time: Action · Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S · Duration: Instantaneous
Classes: Sorcerer, Wizard

You fire a ray of sickly green energy at a creature within range. Make a **ranged spell attack**. On a hit, the target takes **2d8 Poison damage** and has the **Poisoned** condition until the end of your next turn.

Higher-level slot: the damage increases by 1d8 for each slot level above 1.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You aim at a creature within 60 ft.
2. Ranged spell attack against its AC.
3. Hit: 2d8 Poison and Poisoned until the end of your next turn.
4. Miss: nothing.

⚠ Change from 2014

In 2014, the target made a Constitution save after the attack to avoid the Poisoned condition. In 2024, the condition follows **automatically** from a hit.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say what Poisoned does beyond its rules. Fix: refer to the condition (Disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks).

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a sickly green ray striking, the target staggering, nauseous.

Step 1 – Aim:

A visible creature within range (60 ft).

Step 2 – Attack:

Make a ranged spell attack against the target's AC.

Step 3 – Hit:

2d8 Poison damage, and the target has the **Poisoned** condition until the end of your next turn.

Step 4 – Condition effects:

Poisoned gives Disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks (see the condition).

Example: Eliot casts Ray of Sickness at an ogre (AC 11). He rolls 14: a hit. 2d8 = 9 Poison damage, and the ogre is Poisoned until the end of Eliot's next turn.

⚠ Common questions:

Is a saving throw needed?
According to the text, no: a hit is enough.
Table rule

What is the range?
60 ft.

How much damage?
2d8 Poison.

What type of attack?
Ranged spell attack.

How long does the condition last?
Until the end of your next turn.

What does Poisoned do?
Disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks.

Are undead affected?
Only if not immune to Poison.

Does it scale with level?
Yes: +1d8 per level above 1.

⚠ Debate points and table options:
Table rule

No more saving throw
Poisoned follows any hit. **Option**: follow the text; or restore a Constitution save to avoid it.

Immunity
Creatures immune to Poison or to Poisoned. **Option**: neither damage nor condition.

Condition duration
Until the end of your next turn. **Option**: ends at the start; or at the end.

Power
2d8 Poison at 60 ft at level 1. **Option**: keep as is.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Critical Hits
A spell attack can be a Critical Hit: the damage dice are then doubled.

A natural 1
On an attack roll, a natural 1 is an automatic miss; this isn't true for ability checks or saving throws.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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